

Daily Bible Note

Date: August 1, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Ezekiel 34:1-10

1 And the word of the Lord came to me, saying,

2 "Son of man, prophesy against the shepherds of Israel, prophesy and say to them, 'Thus says the Lord God to the shepherds: "Woe to the shepherds of Israel who feed themselves! Should not the shepherds feed the flocks?"

3 "You eat the fat and clothe yourselves with the wool; you slaughter the fatlings, but you do not feed the flock."

4 "The weak you have not strengthened, nor have you healed those who were sick, nor bound up the broken, nor brought back what was driven away, nor sought what was lost; but with force and cruelty you have ruled them."

5 "So they were scattered because there was no shepherd; and they became food for all the beasts of the field when they were scattered."

6 "My sheep wandered through all the mountains, and on every high hill; yes, My flock was scattered over the whole face of the earth, and no one was seeking or searching for them."

7 "'Therefore, you shepherds, hear the word of the Lord:"

8 "'As I live,' says the Lord God, 'surely because My flock became a prey, and My flock became food for every beast of the field, because there was no shepherd, nor did My shepherds search for My flock, but the shepherds fed themselves and did not feed My flock'—"

9 "therefore, O shepherds, hear the word of the Lord!"

10 "Thus says the Lord God: 'Behold, I am against the shepherds, and I will require My flock at their hand; I will cause them to cease feeding the sheep, and the shepherds shall feed themselves no more; for I will deliver My flock from their mouths, that they may no longer be food for them.'"

II. Key Summary

- God tells Ezekiel to speak against the shepherds (leaders) of Israel, because they fed themselves instead of feeding the flock.
 - The passage lists what the shepherds failed to do: they did not strengthen the weak, heal the sick, bind up the injured, or bring back the lost sheep — instead they ruled with force.
 - Because there was no shepherd to watch over them, the flock scattered and became food for wild animals; the Lord declares He will be against these shepherds and hold them accountable.
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III. Passage Analysis

The shepherds forgot why the flock was put in their hands

Woe to the shepherds who feed themselves — they regard their own profit and advantage, not the good of the people committed to their charge. [1]

It was never wrong for a shepherd to receive a living from the flock. What went wrong was putting their own benefit first and the people they were responsible for last. Once the motive was off, the actions followed.

You don't belong to anyone — you belong to God

"My flock" is more than an expression of ownership; it is a term of endearment. [2]

God says "My sheep" four times in this passage, and right after, He makes His stance clear: what happens to the flock matters to Him, and the shepherds must answer for their neglect (v8-10). Shepherds are entrusted to care for the flock, but they need to remember they answer to God — how you treat those placed in your care, God sees it.

IV. Reflection Question

When you're given a role responsible for others — class officer, club leader, church service — do you care more about their good, or what you get out of it?

In Ezekiel 34, God rebukes shepherds entrusted with the flock who cared only about their own benefit, not the flock's needs.

References

[1] BibleHub Commentaries, Benson Commentary on Ezekiel 34,

<https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/ezekiel/34-2.htm>

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik commentary on Ezekiel 34 (quoting Block),

<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/ezekiel-34/>